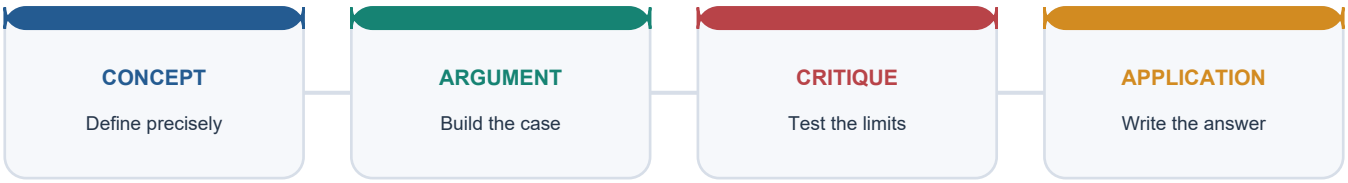
COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

New-Topic Essay Practice Bank

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

New-Topic Essay Practice Bank

> Original repository-authored prompts. These are not UPSC PYQs and carry no official provenance. Use the separate model-answer book only after attempting them.

Ref	Prompt	Provenance
NEW-01	Public trust is the invisible infrastructure of democracy.	Original repository-authored prompt
NEW-02	Artificial intelligence expands human choice only when humans retain agency.	Original repository-authored prompt
NEW-03	Climate resilience begins with local knowledge but cannot end there.	Original repository-authored prompt
NEW-04	Data can improve governance, but dignity must govern data.	Original repository-authored prompt
NEW-05	A clean energy transition must also be a just livelihood transition.	Original repository-authored prompt
NEW-06	The quality of public debate determines the quality of public choice.	Original repository-authored prompt

Attempt protocol

Write one essay in 1000-1200 words. Spend five minutes deconstructing the prompt, build six distinct dimensions, include a counterargument, and review for prompt fidelity before opening the answer book.

Framework and rubric

Essay framework and quality rubric

Target and planning method

The UPSC Essay paper's audited 2024 instruction asks for two essays of about 1000-1200 words each, one from each section. The 1000-1200 range is a target, not a licence to pad. A practical, non-official workflow is:

1. **Deconstruct (5 minutes):** define the key words, identify the hidden tension, convert the prompt into a question, and write a provisional verdict.
2. **Map (8-10 minutes):** generate dimensions across individual, society, polity, economy, technology, environment, ethics, global and time scales.
3. **Select (3 minutes):** retain six or seven distinct claims. Each must have a mechanism, a named example, analysis and a qualification.
4. **Draft (about 65 minutes):** introduction, five or six body clusters, counterargument, synthesis and conclusion. Use transitions that show logic.
5. **Review (5 minutes):** check prompt fidelity, balance, examples, grammar, word range and whether the conclusion is earned rather than sloganised.

Recommended 1000-1200-word architecture

Block	Indicative words	Function
Introduction	110-140	Context, definitions, tension and qualified thesis
Body 1-2	200-240	Individual and social consequences
Body 3-4	200-240	Institutions, economy, polity or technology
Body 5-6	200-240	Environment, ethics, global or intergenerational lens
Counterargument	100-130	Steelman the strongest limit; answer it
Conclusion	90-120	Synthesis, conditions and forward-looking closure

Paragraph engine

Claim -> named example -> mechanism -> analysis -> qualification. A good example is not decoration. Explain why it supports the claim, what its limit is, and how it returns to the prompt.

Quality rubric (100 marks)

Criterion	Marks	Full-credit test
Prompt fidelity	25	Every major paragraph answers the exact proposition
Thesis and reasoning	20	One contestable, qualified thesis with visible logic
Multidimensional depth	20	Distinct scales and sectors, not repeated points
Examples and factual restraint	15	Named, relevant examples without invented statistics
Counterargument and synthesis	10	Serious opposing case refined into a condition
Structure and transitions	5	Introduction, flow, balance and conclusion are easy to follow
Language and originality	5	Clear, precise, reflective and non-template prose

Self-audit before submission

- Is the thesis a claim rather than a restatement?
- Does each body paragraph contain a mechanism and an example?
- Have I distinguished growth from development, access from agency, and charity

from justice where the prompt requires it?

- Have I given the strongest counter-view a fair hearing?
- Is the conclusion a qualified answer to the prompt, not a new topic?
- Are all exact figures, quotations and attributions either verified or omitted?